

Preserving Heritage, Empowering Artisans: A Glimpse into LLDC Craft Museum, Kutch

Bhuj, Kutch – Gujarat:

In a world rapidly modernizing, the **Living and Learning Design Centre (LLDC) Craft Museum** stands as a remarkable tribute to the timeless traditions of Kutch. Established by **Shrujan Trust**, a non-profit organization founded in **1969** by **Late Ms. Chanda Shroff**, LLDC is located in the peaceful village of Ajrakhpur, just 16 km from Bhuj.

For over five decades, Shrujan has empowered more than **3,000 rural women artisans** across 100+ villages through craft revival and dignified livelihood opportunities. It has received prestigious recognitions like the **Rolex Award for Enterprise (2006)**, **International Craft Award (2017)**, and **Nari Shakti Puraskar (2017)** for its contribution to hand embroidery and rural entrepreneurship.

A Living Museum in the Heart of Kutch

LLDC is not just a museum — it is a living, breathing ecosystem of creativity and heritage. Spread over **9 acres**, the centre was established in **2016** to serve as a space for **craft education, exhibitions, research, and community engagement**. It showcases the exquisite artistry of **12 embroidery communities** in Kutch and celebrates over **40 traditional styles**.

Highlights of the Museum:

- **The Living Embroideries of Kutch Gallery:** Presenting the living tradition of Kutch embroidery, with the **10th exhibition currently ongoing**.
- **Under the Embroidered Sky Gallery:** The last exhibition featured the rich embroidery traditions of **Ahir and Meghwaad Gurjar communities**. The current Show in this gallery is **The Embroideries of the Mutva community of Banni**.
- **Inspiration Gallery:** Hosting contemporary and global art and craft exhibitions. So far, 13 exhibitions have been presented, currently **"One Stitch Many Names"** ongoing. The previous exhibitions include:

Devotional Textiles, Aari – A One-Stitch-Many-Splendored Embroidery, Zari - Fabric and Metal in Harmony, Banaras – A Brocade Story, Tanchhoi,

Of Braids & Magic, Sindh and Kutch Part – I, Sindh and Kutch Part – II, Sindh and Kutch Part – III, Tradition And Innovation – The Journey in the Craft of Weaving of Vishram Valji, Dastan E Gul-Duzee: Embroideries of Afghanistan, and Mamadbhai Je Umbhare – Ajrakh: Family, Fabric, Fashion.

- **Hands-on Gallery:** Interactive zones where visitors can experience embroidery, block printing, weaving, tie & dye and pottery.
- **Crafts Archives & Library:** Housing over **11,000 artifacts**, research materials, and an ever-growing documentation of Kutch's craft legacy.

The museum also organizes lectures, live demonstrations, and cultural programs, building a vital bridge between traditional artisans and modern audiences.

Workshops: A Hands-on Craft Experience

LLDC offers a variety of short-term, professionally guided workshops conducted by master artisans, enabling visitors to directly engage with Kutch's vibrant crafts:

- **Ajrakh Block Printing:**
 - 1-Day Introduction
 - 3-Day Comprehensive Course (including history, tools, pigment preparation, and souvenir creation)
- **Pottery:**
 - 1-Day Introduction
 - 2-Day & 3-Day Comprehensive Courses (covering history, materials, kiln setup, and personal souvenir making)
- **Mud Craft (Lippan Kaam):**
 - 1-Day Introduction
 - 2-Day Detailed Course (including clay preparation, tool use, color, and mirror inlay)
- **Bandhani Tie & Dye:**
 - 1-Day Introduction
 - 2-Day Comprehensive Course (covering dyeing methods, creating personalized Bandhani pieces)
- **Leather Craft:**
 - 1-Day Introduction
 - 2-Day In-depth Course (including crafting personal leather souvenirs)

- **Embroidery:**
 - 1-Day Introduction
 - 2-Day Comprehensive Course (covering styles, history, and hands-on stitching practice)

These workshops are carefully designed for both hobbyists and serious learners. Prior registration is required, with a minimum group size of five participants. Full details are available on the LLDC website.

Nurturing Future Artisans & Researchers

LLDC actively **welcomes interns from art, craft, design, and related academic fields**, offering them exposure to authentic craft traditions, field research, documentation, and artisan interaction.

Events that Celebrate Culture

The **LLDC Winter Festival**, held annually from **19th to 23rd January**, brings together the rich crafts, music, dance, and cuisine of Kutch along with guest state collaborations. Past partnerships have included the **North Eastern States, Jammu & Kashmir, Madhya Pradesh, and Odisha**. In addition to this, LLDC celebrates International Yoga Day, and International Museum Day, while organizing year-round workshops, exhibitions, and folk performances.

Amenities and Visitor Experience

To make every visit memorable, LLDC offers:

- An **auditorium & conference hall** for programs
- A peaceful **library** and **craft research centre**
- **Café & canteen** serving local delicacies
- A **museum shop** offering authentic handmade crafts directly from artisans

Whether you are a craft enthusiast, student, researcher, or cultural traveler, LLDC promises a deeply immersive and inspiring experience.

Visit & Connect

📍 LLDC Craft Museum, 705, Bhuj-Bhachau Road, Opp. Anchor Factory, Ajrakhpur, Bhuj – 370105, Gujarat

🕒 Timings: 10:00 am to 6:00 pm (Closed on Mondays & Public Holidays)

☎ Contact: +91 2832 229090 | +91 89803 29090

🌐 Website: www.shrujanlldc.org

✉ Email: info@shrujanlldc.org

📱 Social Media: linktr.ee/lldcshrujan

➡️ Virtual Tour: shrujanlldc.org/vtour